

Up the rails, *down the coast*

At a glance

NOVEMBER 2026

The whole trip on one grid — colour-coded by region, travel days flagged. You land Sunday the 1st and fly home Saturday the 14th.

SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT
1 LAND 07:35 ✈	2 BANGKOK	3 NIGHT TRAIN 🚆	4 CHIANG MAI	5 CHIANG MAI	6 CHIANG MAI	7 FLY SOUTH ✈
8 KRABI	9 KRABI	10 TRANSFER IN 🔄	11 360 ISSARA	12 360 ISSARA	13 FLY TO BKK ✈	14 FLY 20:45 ✈
15	16	17	18	19	20	21
22	23	24 + YI PENG	25 + LOY KRATHONG	26	27	28
29	30					

 Bangkok  Chiang Mai  Krabi  Khao Sok ➔ marks a travel / transit day

Bangkok — *arrival*

Land at 7:35am and give yourself a soft start: temple-hop the old city, eat your way down the Chao Phraya, and shake off the flight before the **night train north**.

SUN

1

NOV

ARRIVE

Land & ease in

- Clear immigration; ARL to Phaya Thai, then BTS Sukhumvit to **Ploen Chit** — the Ritz is a 10-min walk at One Bangkok.
- Late morning: **Wat Pho** and its giant reclining Buddha, then a foot massage at the temple's own school.
- Sunset boat on the Chao Phraya; riverside dinner with **Wat Arun** lit up across the water. Early night — you've earned it.

STAY Ritz-Carlton • 90034653

→ EK374 arr 07:35

check-in 15:00 — ask early

Grand old Bangkok

- Open-of-day at the **Grand Palace & Wat Phra Kaew** (Emerald Buddha), before heat and crowds.
- Ferry across to **Wat Arun**; climb the central prang for the view.
- Afternoon: Jim Thompson House or a cool-down spa hour. Evening: **Yaowarat** Chinatown street-food crawl.

STAY Ritz-Carlton

MRT Lumphini 300 m



TUE

3

NOV

DEPART

Markets, then the rails

- Slow morning: a **Maeklong railway + Damnoen Saduak floating market** half-day, or a guided food tour.
- Afternoon: coffee, a massage, and pack an overnight bag you can reach on the train.
- **18:40**: board Special Express #9 at Krung Thep Aphiwat — e-tickets issued. Dinner in the dining car, berths down.

🚂 TRAIN 18:40 → 07:15

at station by 18:10

SLEEPER #9 ·
TICKETED

STATE RAILWAY OF THAILAND ·
SPECIAL EXPRESS

NIGHT 03

Sleep on
the move

18:40

≈ 13 h · 751 km

07:15

KRUNG THEP APHIWAT

overnight

CHIANG MAI

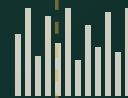
Bangkok · Tue 3 Nov

Wed 4 Nov (+1)

CLASS 2nd A/C sleeper × 2

REF ...6901 / ...6902

KTW → CGM



Be at the station by
18:10.

Chiang Mai — *the north*

Wake up in the mountains. Lanna temples, an **ethical elephant day**, cooking classes and cool air — the exhale after Bangkok's heat.

Heads-up on lanterns: the famous Yi Peng / Loy Krathong festival lands about **Nov 24–25** this year — roughly ten days after you fly home. You'll narrowly miss the sky lanterns, so plan Chiang Mai around its year-round temples and jungle rather than the festival.

WED

4

NOV

ARRIVE

Off the train, into the Old City

- Arrive 07:15; breakfast near the station, check in inside the moat.
- Temple wander on foot: **Wat Chedi Luang**, **Wat Phra Singh**, and the quiet lanes between.
- Evening: the Night Bazaar and a bowl of **khao soi**, the north's signature curry noodle.

STAY Chiang Mai

arr 07:15

THU

5

NOV

DAY TRIP

Elephants, done right

- Full day at an **ethical sanctuary** (Elephant Nature Park and similar) — feeding and observing, no riding.
- Back by evening; unwind in **Nimman**, the café and craft-beer district.

STAY Chiang Mai

book the sanctuary ahead



FRI

6

NOV

EXPLORE

Mountain temple & a wok

- Morning: **Wat Phra That Doi Suthep**, the gold chedi on the mountain above the city.
- Afternoon: a hands-on **Thai cooking class** — or chase waterfalls at Doi Inthanon if you'd rather be in nature.
- Repack for the tropics; tomorrow you fly to the Andaman.

STAY Chiang Mai

fly south tomorrow



Fly Chiang Mai → Krabi

CNX → KBV · direct · book early

Sat 7 Nov · morning

≈ 2 h in the air

03 / 05

Krabi — *the Andaman*

SAT 7 → TUE 10 NOV

Swap mountains for limestone and sea. [Longtail boats](#), [castaway beaches](#), and karst cliffs rising straight out of turquoise water.



SAT

7

NOV

ARRIVE

Fly south, feet in the sand

- Morning flight down; transfer to **Ao Nang** or boat over to **Railay**.
- Afternoon on the beach, first Andaman sunset, a long seafood dinner.

→ FLY CNX→KBV

STAY Ao Nang / Railay



SUN

8

NOV

ISLANDS

Island-hop

- Full-day boat trip: the **Hong Islands** lagoon or the classic **4-Islands** — Phra Nang cave beach, Tup, Chicken, Poda.
- Snorkel, swim, beach lunch; back for sunset.

STAY Krabi

reef-safe sunscreen



MON

9

NOV

EXPLORE

Cliffs, jungle & steam

- Sunrise option: the **Tiger Cave Temple's** 1,260 steps for the summit view over the plains.
- Or the inland **Emerald Pool & hot springs** in the rainforest; easy afternoon back at the beach.

STAY Krabi

drive to Khao Sok tomorrow

Transfer Krabi → 360° Issara



included in package · meet 500Rai Pier Office, Chiew Larn

Tue 10 Nov · boat 12:00 or 15:30
≈ 2 h road + 1.5 h boat

Khao Sok — *on the lake*

TUE 10 → FRI 13 NOV

Three nights **floating on Cheow Lan Lake** at 360° Issara, ringed by limestone towers in one of the oldest rainforests on earth. The centrepiece of the trip.

Transfers are included. The package covers a private car from Krabi (~2 h) to the 500 Rai Pier Office at Chiew Larn, then a 1.5 h longtail. Scheduled boats leave the pier at **12:00 or 15:30 only**. Pack small — you climb down stairs to the boat, and big cases can stay at the pier office. Bring **THB 340 each in cash** for the national park fee.

TUE
10
NOV

ARRIVE

Drive, then the longtail

- Leave Krabi mid-morning — about **2 h by road** to Chiew Larn, for the 12:00 boat.
- **1.5 h by longtail** across the lake, sightseeing on the way; the resort appears like a floating village.
- Check in from 14:00, swim off the deck, set dinner over the water.
17:00: wildlife safari & sunset cruise.

STAY 360° Issara

booking 0592406

3-Night Essence · all-in

WED

11

NOV

THE LAKE

Nowhere to be

- Kayak straight off your own balcony — each room has one.
- Swim in the fresh water, read, watch the light move across the karsts.
- **Pakarang Cave Trail** at 09:45 — 1.5 km trek plus a bamboo raft (THB 200 each, cash).

STAY 360° Issara

A/C 12:00-06:00 only

THU

12

NOV

DAWN

Last full day on the water

- Morning lake sightseeing — gibbons, hornbills and elephants along the shoreline.
- **Prakai Petch Cave Trail** — swamp forest, small waterfalls, glittering cave (runs Mon/Wed/Sat, so today works).
- Last sunset cruise at 17:00. Pack tonight — **check-out is 10:00**.

STAY 360° Issara

check-out 10:00



Boat, car, then fly → Bangkok

360° Issara → Chiew Larn → Surat Thani (URT) → BKK

Fri 13 Nov · boat 10:30

reaches URT ~13:00

Bangkok — *the finale*

FRI 13 → SAT 14 NOV

One night back in the capital, then a **full final day** — the 20:45 flight leaves the whole Saturday open.

FRI

13

NOV

RETURN

Off the lake, into the city

- Breakfast, check out at 10:00, scheduled boat at 10:30, car to Surat Thani — at URT about 13:00.
- **VZ353 18:50 → 20:00** into Bangkok. (VZ355 at 13:10 needs a THB 5,000 private boat leaving 10:00.)
- Late dinner near the hotel — you land at 20:00.

→ FLY URT→BKK 18:50

STAY Bangkok

SAT

14

NOV

DEPART

Fly home

- A full last day — ICONSIAM, Ayutthaya, or whatever you missed. Your flight is in the evening.
- Leave the city by **~5:00pm** for Suvarnabhumi — allow for traffic.
- **20:45**: EK373 to Dubai, then JFK at 08:15 Sunday.

→ DEP EK373 20:45

at airport by ~17:45

Before you go

- 01 **Train #9 is ticketed.** Two 2nd-class A/C berths (res. 34511470), Bangkok 18:40 → Chiang Mai 07:15.
- 02 **Booked.** Emirates H2M5FJ, Ritz-Carlton (90034653), Sleeper #9, FD3072 (UYTUHF), 360° Issara (0592406). The Krabi transfer is included in the package.
- 03 **Great timing.** Early November is the front edge of the cool, dry season — the Andaman is drying out and Khao Sok is at its lushest.
- 04 **One flight left to book.** VZ353 at 18:50 on the 13th fits the resort's 10:30 boat; VZ355 at 13:10 only works with a THB 5,000 private boat.
- 05 **Cash for the park fee.** THB 340 per person on arrival at Khao Sok, plus THB 200 each for the Pakarang cave trail — not included.
- 06 **This is a shape, not a script.** Every night is movable — treat it as a strong default and bend it to your energy.

DOWNLOAD ITINERARY (PDF)

DOWNLOAD CALENDAR (PDF, PRINT LANDSCAPE)

// 14 days · 13 nights · Bangkok — Chiang Mai — Krabi — Khao Sok — Bangkok · Nov 2026